games against Australia). The Australians had also hammered us 2-0 in the Test series – results that only reinforced the ‘chokers’ tag the media had pinned on our jerseys.

All of which makes getting pissed the night before the big game not a very good idea at all. But that’s me, I guess. I do stuff. Often it’s only in hindsight that I am able to judge the merits of my decisions. Fortunately I got away with this one. And I have, besides my natural talent, two things to thank for what’s probably my most famous innings … Mypaid and Red Bull.

Before leaving my hotel room that morning I had grabbed two Red Bull energy drinks from the mini-bar and a handful of Mypaid tablets. These little tablets, let me tell you, are the best things ever invented. Especially for hangovers. And I should know – I’ve had a few. Mypaid is a superb cocktail of painkilling substances with an anti-inflammatory, which just zaps anything resembling a hangover. You can buy them over the counter, too. I’m never without them. (Jeez, this is such a good punt, the pharmaceutical company should be paying me for this.)

Anyway, so I knocked back my little cocktail and, under the highly annoyed gaze of our bowling coach Vinnie Barnes (who knew what I’d been up to the night before), took to the field.

Thank the Lord we were fielding. I really, really wasn’t feeling very good at all. Fortunately, though, that wasn’t evident to anyone watching. I did drop one catch, but it was a total screamer from Adam Gilchrist. Even getting to that ball had been an unbelievable effort on my part. I doubt that I would’ve caught it even without a hangover. But my head was gradually clearing and, as luck would have it, not many balls were coming my way on the field.

The Australian innings was a bit of a blur, to be honest – not only because of my state of mind, but also because of their batting performance. Adam Gilchrist, Simon Katich and Michael Hussey all hammered us, but that was nothing compared to captain Ricky Ponting’s 164 off 105 balls. I remember Mark Boucher and I sort of looked at each other at about 350 and Bouchie said, ‘Jeez, we’re going to be chasing 380 here.’

My money was on something closer to 400. As it turns out, we were both wrong. Ponting and Andrew Symonds climbed into Roger Telemachus, hitting him for plenty in the 48th over. Our bowlers also sent down a few no-balls, which didn’t help matters. Australia ended on 434/4, breaking the